

Types of Narratives – Author-Driven and Reader-Driven Transcript

Now, what are the different narrative types in data storytelling? One is author driven, second is reader driven, and there is a hybrid called narrative driven. Author driven stories are linear, they are static, magazines, presentations, or infographics which are done by the author and they stand on themselves and you have to interpret them. Or the author has a sequence in which you it allows you to interpret.

It is more like they first guide you and then allow you to explore, but there is a strict control on how the author wants you to perceive the message. On the opposite, you have a reader driven paradigm or reader driven narrative framework where it is more of exploratory. For example, you create a tableau or a Power BI dashboard, there is a drill down function, you try to explore the data set, the functionality is enabled to you and you draw your insights, and then there is a narrative that is built around it.

Then you have the narrative storytelling framework which interacts both. You have an interactive slide where there is some amount of author driven construct, the basic visualisation is made because the author thinks this has to be shown, but he allows for interactive elements like changing the state. Let us take for the example voting shares or the constituency wise winning percentages that we have discussed in earlier classes.

You can give a drop down interactive chart just by enabling the state. You can change the state and see how the voting percentages are changing across the state. Though author is fixing you to see only the winning margins, he is allowing some amount of flexibility to build your own narrative.

That is how these three styles vary. One is driven by the author, another is driven by the reader, and the narrative storytelling framework which marries both has elements of both author driven and reader driven framework because there is interactivity. Now, what are the different dimensions of narrative storytelling? There are three dimensions.

First is the genres. It can be an annotated chart, a comic strip, slideshow, video, or a flowchart. All these are narrative.

So, you can tell your narrative using this. It's a genre. Whether you are using an annotated chart or you using a flowchart to build your narrative.

Similarly, there are visual narrative tactics. Are you visually structuring the story or the data presentation? Are you using highlighting or transitions or animations? These are part of your narrative. Somebody can tell a very linear story by playing slides one after another.



Somebody can take a pause, highlight certain slides, bring in animations, or use normal plain text in a different highlighted format to drive home his points and that is a different narrative state. So, again, narrative tactics can be part of narrative tactics or part of narrative storytelling, which will enhance your message delivery. Finally, you have narrative frameworks, which is ordering, interactivity, and messaging.

So, we have these interactive elements, which are used in dashboard building to bring out the data story.

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